

# **The Architecture of Contentious Cycles**

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## **Chapter One: The Onset of Contention**

Contentious episodes begin not with the loudest grievance but with the first instance in which previously isolated complaints are recognized by their bearers as instances of a shared condition.

## **Chapter Two: Escalation Dynamics**

Once a shared grievance is recognized, escalation follows a predictable sequence from informal gatherings to semi-formal assemblies.

## **Chapter Three: Settlement and Aftermath**

Every episode surveyed here eventually settles, whether through negotiated concession, exhaustion, or suppression.